

Essentials of Project Management



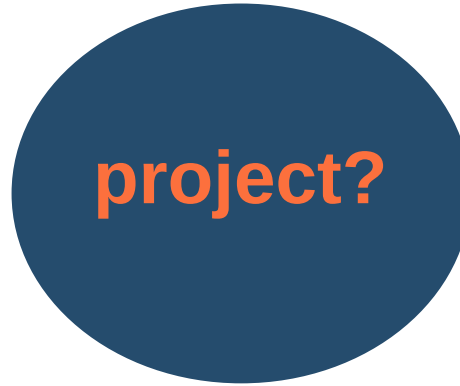
Expectations



Project Management

Temporary endeavor

Definite beginning and end



Unique Output

Several Phases

What is project management?

The application of **knowledge**, **skills**, **tools**, and **techniques** to project activities to meet the project requirements.



Project Life Cycle

1

Initiation

2

Planning

3

Execution

4

Monitoring & Controlling

5

Closure

Congratulation,

**we have
accepted your
proposal**



1- project onboarding/kickoff meeting

Before the meeting

Search about the company

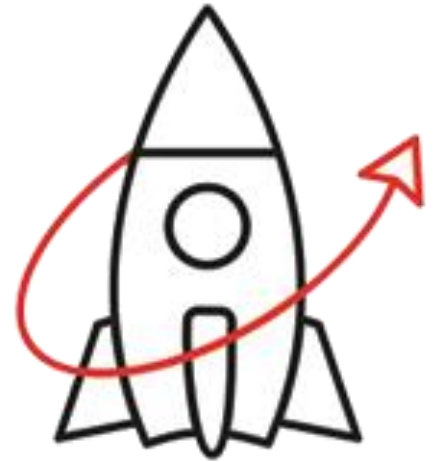
Search about the Client

Prepare your Questions

Prepare yourself

Freelancer Onboarding/Kick-Off Meeting Agenda

- Introductions, project name, and overview
- Review of the project goals and objectives
- Timelines and milestones
- Project risks
- Assignment of roles and responsibilities
- Tools and methods
- Q&A
- Next steps



2 - Project Scope

1- Collect Requirements

2- Define Scope

3- Create Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

1- Collecting Requirements:

This involves gathering information from the client about:

- what they **want to achieve** with the project
- what their **specific needs** are, and what **outcomes they expect**.

This can involve discussions, interviews, surveys, or other methods of gathering information. The goal is to get a **clear understanding** of the client's **expectations** and **requirements** for the project.

Why is it important to gather requirements?

Requirements gathering is critical to get client on the same page and bringing clarity and agreement on the path you're about to take together.

1. Avoid scope creep

2. Reduce wasted energy

3. Bring comfort through clarity

4. Reduce risk

2- Define Scope

- Based on the requirements gathered, the next step is to define the scope of the project.
- This involves identifying the specific tasks, goals, deliverables, and expectations for the project, as well as any constraints or limitations that need to be considered.
- The scope should be clearly defined and documented, so that both the client and the freelancer are on the same page about what work needs to be done and how it will be accomplished.



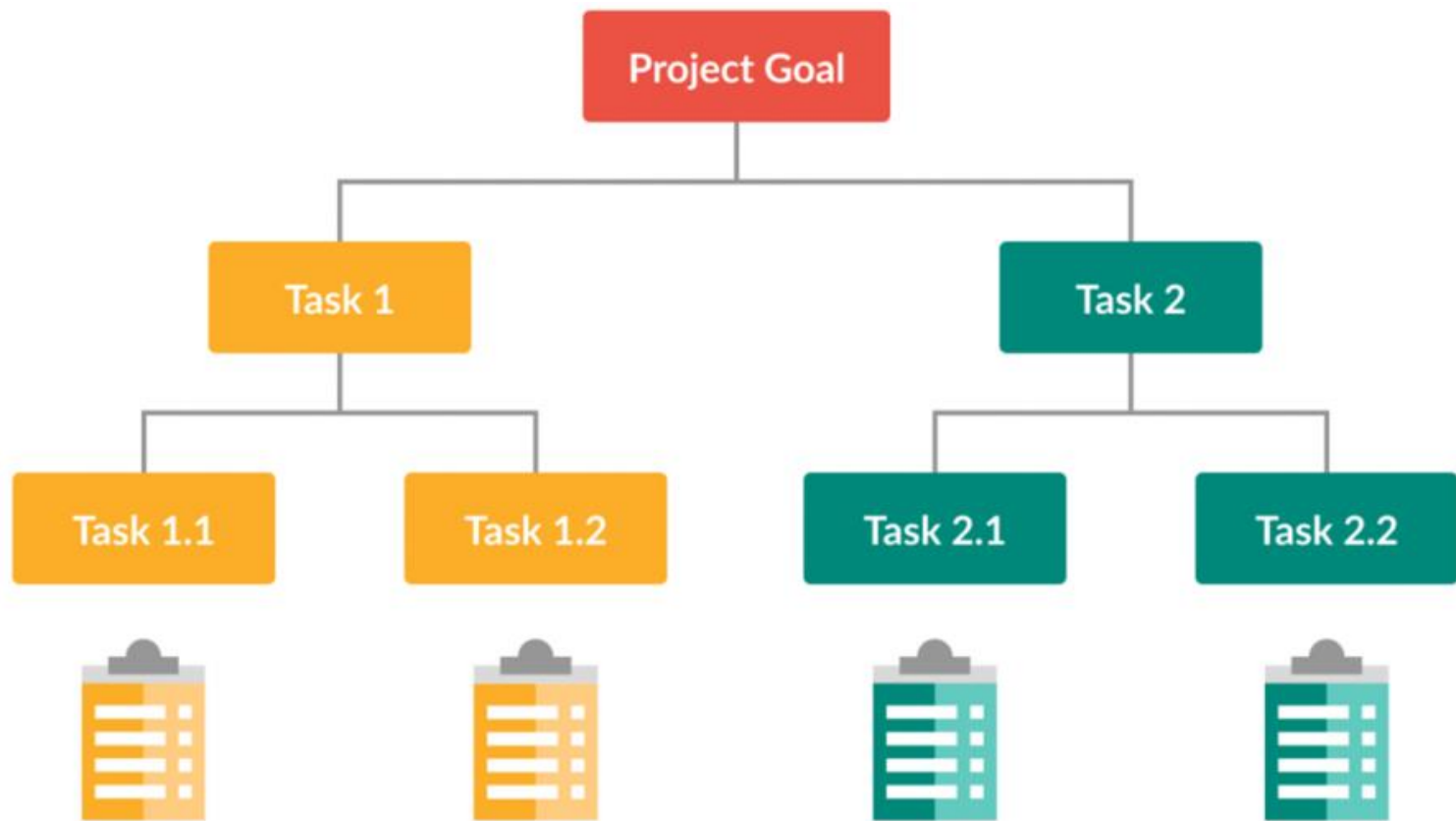
3- Create WBS

The WBS is a **hierarchical decomposition** of the project into smaller, more manageable tasks.

It breaks down the project into smaller, more manageable components, and helps to identify the tasks and activities required to complete each component.

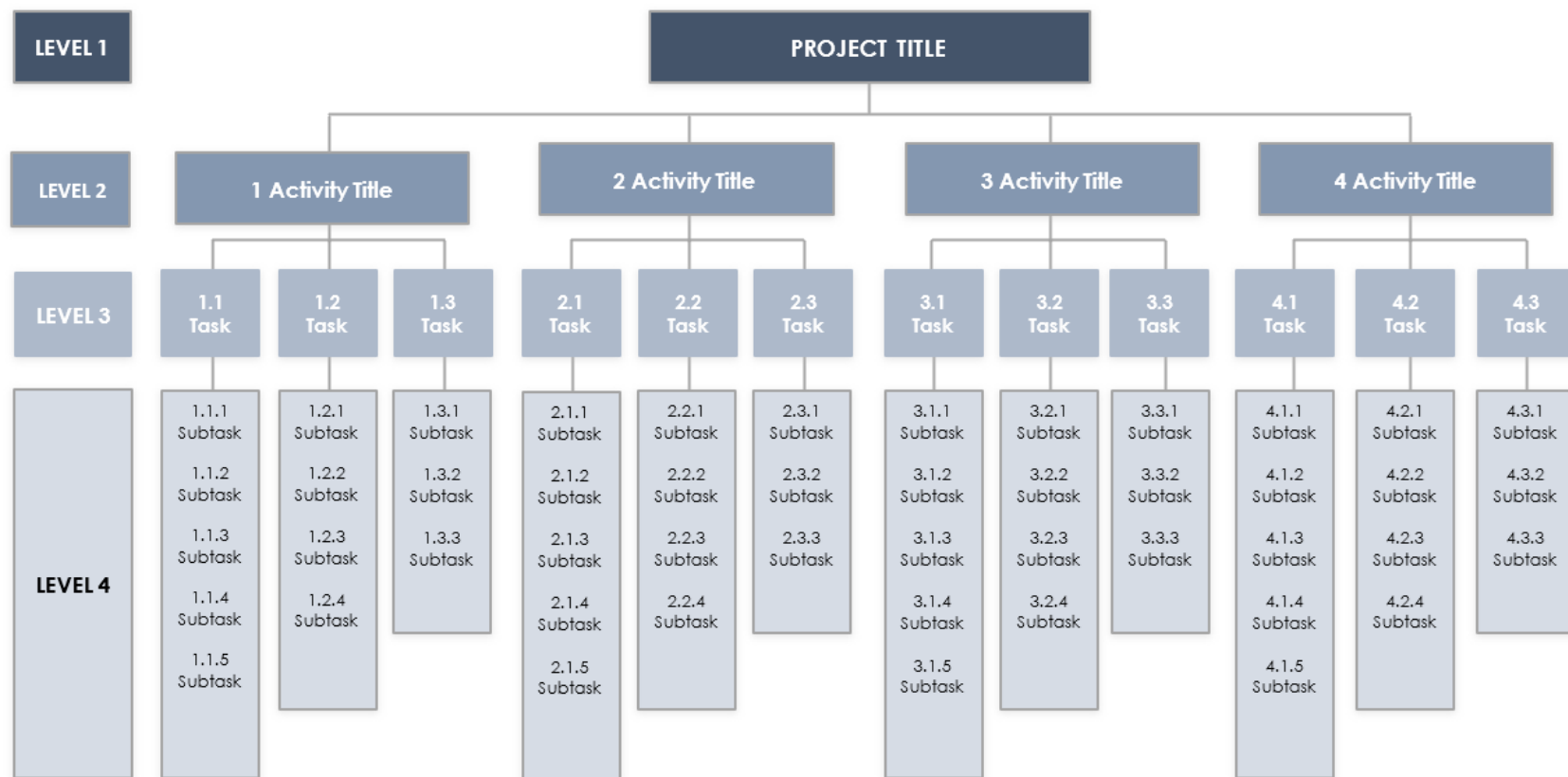
The WBS should include all the tasks required to complete the project, organized into **a logical structure** that makes it easy to manage and track progress.





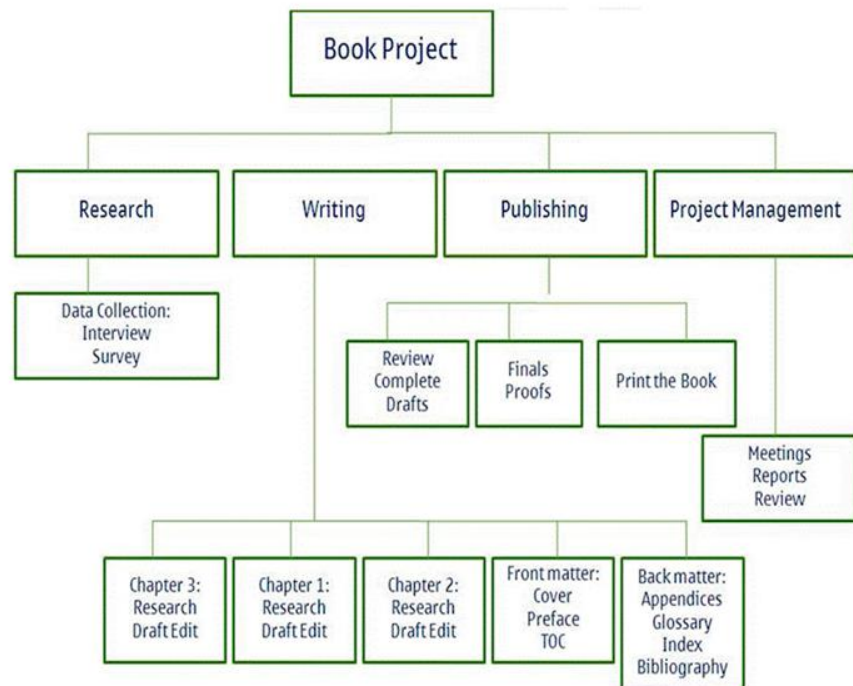
WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE LEVELS TEMPLATE

PROJECT TITLE		COMPANY NAME	
PROJECT MANAGER		DATE	

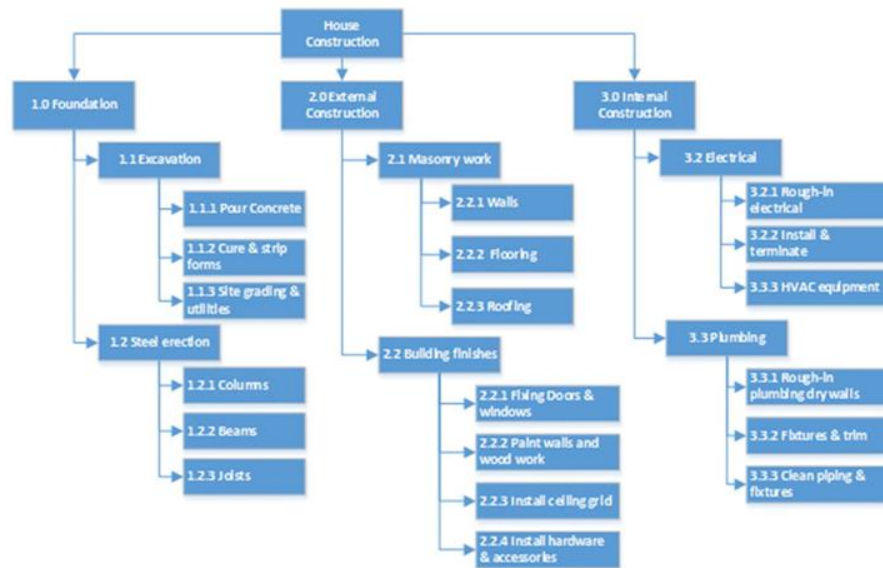


Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) examples

Project : Book Writing



Project : House Construction



Let's Work Together

Create WBS



3- Project Schedule

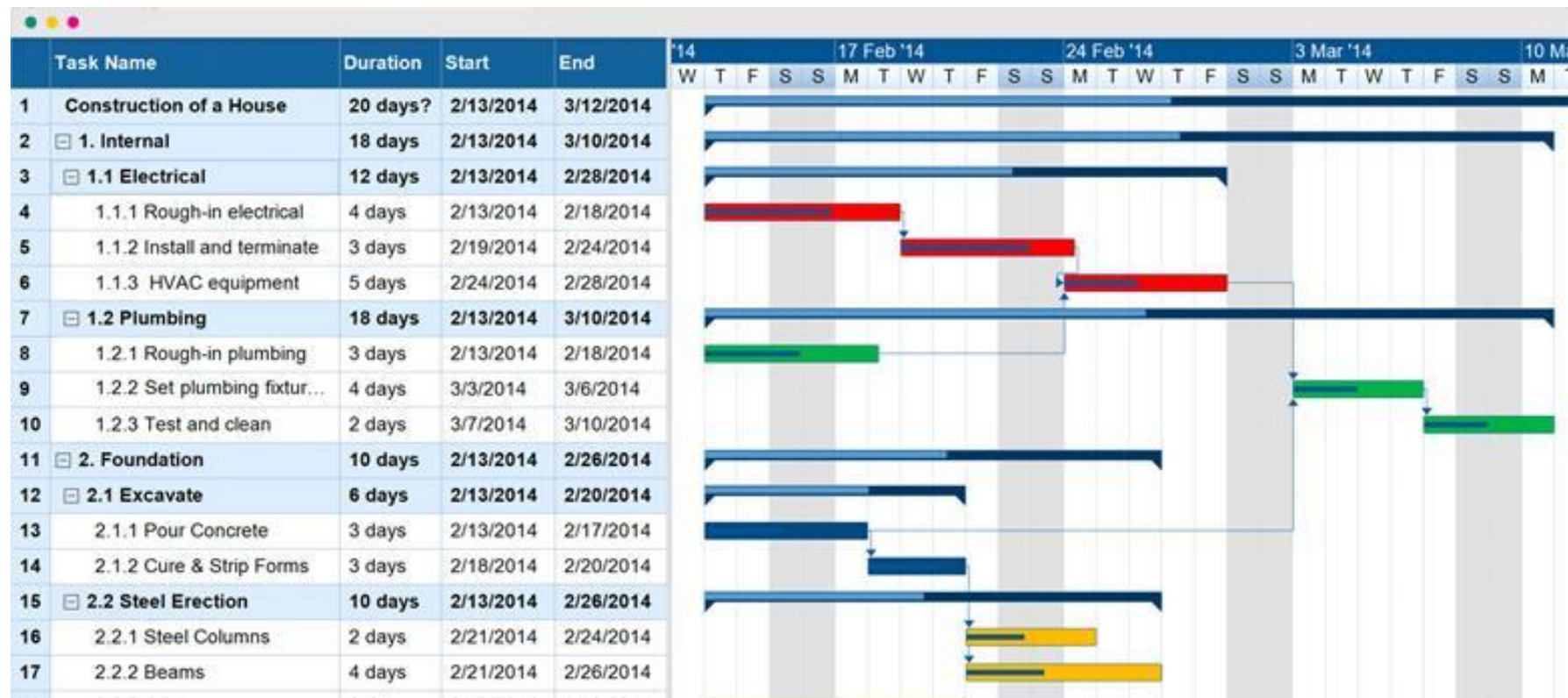
Estimate Activity Durations



Develop Schedule

[illegible]

Gantt chart



Project Schedule



Reserve Analysis

Buffer Time, reserve or contingency added by project team as percentage or value as a recognition of **project risk**.

تحليل الاحتياطي

الوقت الاحتياطي أو وقت للطوارئ الذي يضيفه فريق المشروع كنسبة مئوية أو قيمة كاعتراف بمخاطر المشروع.

Let's Work Together

Develop Schedule



Time Management For Freelancers

Time Management For Freelancers



Agenda

- Time and Time Management
- Time Wasters
- 6 Time management strategies
- Time Management Tips

FACTS ABOUT TIME

A scarce Source

Control over time = Control over life

Time Management = Self Management

We never seem to have enough of it, yet always wasting it

Time Management

Time **management** is the ability to use your time **productively** and **efficiently**.

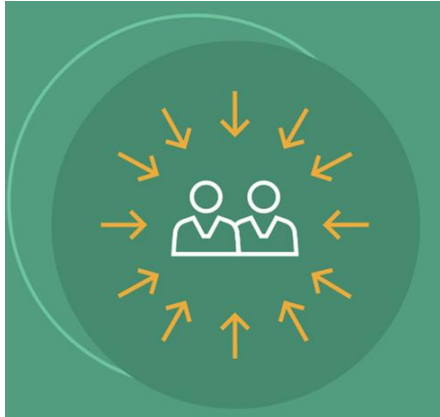
You could also think of it as the **art of having time to do everything that you need**

What is the common Time Management challenges faced by freelancers?

ANSWER



Time Wasters



Internal



External

Internal Time Waster

- Lack of objectives, priorities, deadlines and daily Plan
 - Indecision and procrastination
 - Inability to say “No”
 - Lack of self - discipline
 - Cluttered desk and personal disorganization
 - Leaving tasks unfinished
 - Attempting too much and unrealistic estimates
- الافتقار إلى الأهداف والأولويات والمواعيد النهائية والخطة اليومية
 - التردد والتسويف
 - عدم القدرة على قول "لا"
 - الافتقار إلى الانضباط الذاتي
 - المكتب المزدحم وعدم التنظيم الشخصي
 - ترك المهام غير مكتملة
 - محاولة القيام بالكثير والتقدير غير الواقعية

External Time Waster

- Interruptions (Calls, drop-in visitors,..)
- Unclear communications and instructions
- Inadequate, inaccurate or delayed information

- الانقطاعات (المكالمات، الزوار المفاجئون،..)
- الاتصالات والتعليمات غير الواضحة
- المعلومات غير الكافية أو غير الدقيقة أو المتأخرة

To find your time wasters

For 7 days, try tracking your day-to-day activities

Time	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
12:00 AM							
12:15 AM							
12:30 AM							
12:45 AM							
1:00 AM							
1:15 AM							
1:30 AM							
1:45 AM							
2:00 AM							
2:15 AM							
2:30 AM							
2:45 AM							
3:00 AM							

plan your
**BEST
YEAR**

*Setting Up Your Planning Day
for Year Long Success!*

6 Time Management Strategies

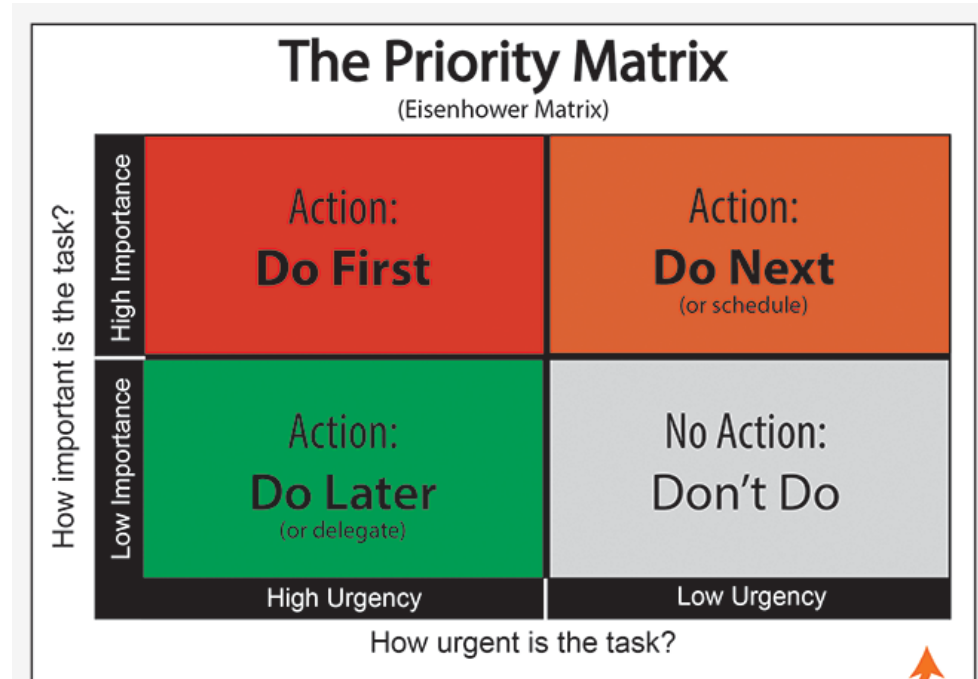


1- Activity Log



2- Prioritizing Tasks

The Eisenhower Matrix



مصفوفة أيزنهاور

	ليس عاجلاً	عاجل
مهمة	قرر حدد موعداً لفعالها	افعل افعلها الآن
ليست مهمة	احذف استبعدها	فوضها من يمكنه فعالها من أجلك؟

3- Create Schedule



WEEKLY SCHEDULE

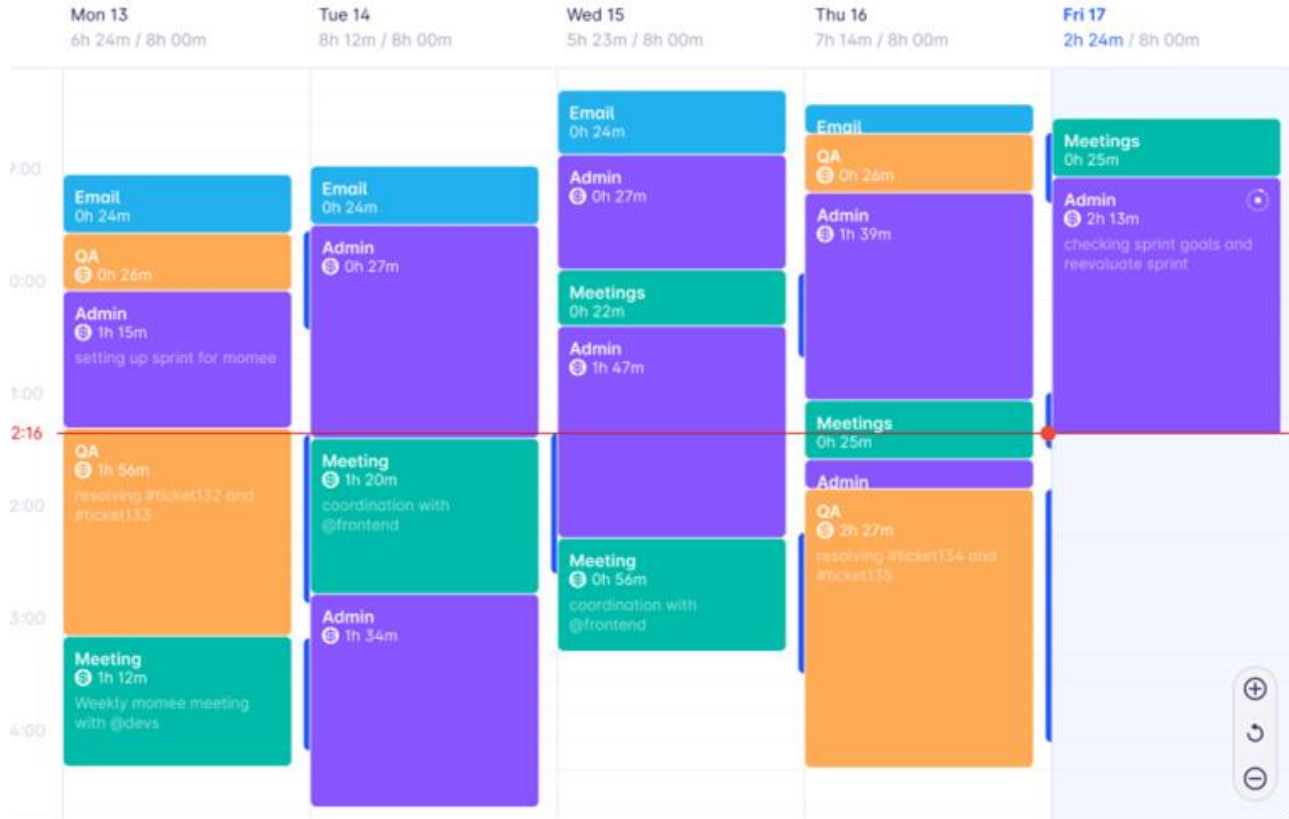
	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
8:00 AM	Work, Coffee Break	Work, Coffee Break	Work	Work, Coffee Break	Work, Coffee Break
9:00 AM	Work, Meeting	Work	Work, Coffee Break	Work	Work, Meeting
10:00 AM	Work	Work	Work	Work	Work
11:00 AM	Work	Work	Work, Meeting	Work	Work, Lunch
12:00 PM	Work, Lunch	Work, Lunch	Work	Work, Lunch	Work
1:00 PM	Work	Work	Work, Lunch	Work, Meeting	Work
2:00 PM	Work	Work	Work, Coffee Break	Work	Work, Coffee Break
3:00 AM	Work, Coffee Break	Work, Training	Work	Work	Work
4:00 PM	Work	Work, Training	Work	Work, Coffee Break	Work
5:00 PM	Work	Work, Coffee Break	Work, Coffee Break	Work	
6:00 PM		Work	Work	Work	
7:00 PM			Work		



Weekly schedule



	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
8 a.m.				Technical Writing (B267)			
9 a.m.		Designing Technical Doc (B267)	Info planning and management (B220)	Technical Writing (B267)			
10 a.m.	Technical Writing (P215)	Designing Technical Doc (B267)	Info planning and management (B220)	Editing (B142)			
11 a.m.	Technical Writing (P215)						
12 p.m.		Selected Topics (B232)					
1 p.m.		Selected Topics (B232)					
2 p.m.							
3 p.m.							
4 p.m.	Desktop Publishing (B182)						
5 p.m.	Desktop Publishing (B182)						
6 p.m.	Desktop Publishing (B182)						
7 p.m.		Karate (7:45)	I				
8 p.m.							
9 p.m.							



4- Time Tracking



5- Minimizing Distractions

1. Have a Plan the Night Before

2. Turn Off the Distractions

3. Use Visual Reminders

4. Batch Check Everything

5. Take Breaks Often

6- Review and Reflection

Weekly

Monthly

Quarterly

Yearly

10

TIME MANAGEMENT TIPS

1 Keep your time in check



2 Take breaks in between



3 Plan in advance



4 Set correct goals



5 Organize your tasks



6 Eliminate distractions



7 Avoid Multitasking



8 Meditate and Exercise



9 Prioritize Tasks



10 Delegate



Manage Your Finances as a Freelancer

Manage Your Finances as a Freelancer

Session Outlines:

1. Financial Plan
2. Create your Budget
3. Ways of Investment

Financial Planning

The process of taking a comprehensive look at your financial situation and building a specific financial plan to reach your goals.



Current Status



Your Goals

Review your expenses and Income



3 Types of financial Goals



Creating Smart Financial



4- Implementation

3- Strategize

2- Prioritize

1- Categorize



The opportunity cost

The value of what you have to give up in order to choose something else.

تتخلى عن شىء من اجل شىء اخر



Budget

Estimate of income and expenditure for a set period of time

تقدير الدخل والنفقات لفترة زمنية محددة



Create your Budget

الدخل	يناير	فبراير	مارس	أبريل	مايو	يونيو	يوليو	أغسطس	سبتمبر	أكتوبر	نوفمبر	ديسمبر	مجموع كلي
مصدر دخل 1													
مصدر دخل 2													
مجموع الدخل الشهري													

المصروفات	يناير	فبراير	مارس	أبريل	مايو	يونيو	يوليو	أغسطس	سبتمبر	أكتوبر	نوفمبر	ديسمبر	مجموع كلي
مجموع ال مصاريف الشهرية													

مجموع الدخل الشهري													
مجموع المصاريف الشهرية													
قدر الادخار الشهري													

Static vs Flexible Budget



Adjust for
actual volume?

Static



Flexible



Let's Work Together

Create your Budget

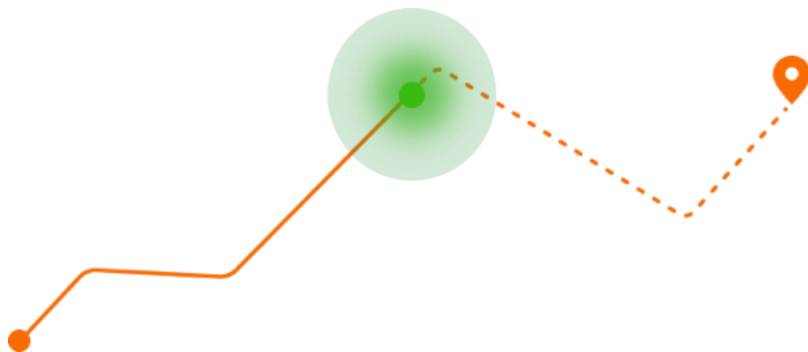


Tracking Income and Expenses

Daily

Weekly

Monthly



Decrease expenses

Increase Income

Saving



Investment



Investment Methods

Real Estate

Goods

Bond

Money Markets

Stock

Let's Work Together

Case Study



Managing Clients

Types Of Difficult Clients And How To Handle Them Effectively



#1

Mr. I Needed This Done Yesterday



General lack of awareness of the space-time continuum; belief that simply having ideas means work is completed.



Be straightforward—if they expect the impossible, educate them to reality.

#2

Mr. I'm Not Really
Sure What I Want



Constant change of heart; says one thing on a call but has a completely different opinion in an email an hour later.



Get everything in writing once an approach is decided upon; reject major course-correction after the fact.

#3



Mr. What's a Weekend?



Sending emails at 3 a.m. every day; scheduling meetings for after business hours; wondering why you didn't complete that project on Christmas Day.



Don't be afraid to say no if what they want will take too much of a toll on your staff.

Ms. I Hate That Color
for No Reason



Propensity for latching onto a small feature, color, font, or word in a project and bringing work to a grinding halt as a result.



Don't ask their favorite color, ask what they want to accomplish. Display your expertise by recommending options that achieve those goals. If they're still unhappy, consider dumping them.

Mr. Hey What's That
Over There, aka,
Mr. I Assumed This
Was Included



Insistence on getting a little bit more out of your team each time you talk; frequent requests to expand the scope of the project.



Agree to do out-of-scope work only at an added upfront cost.

Ms. Lurker



Disappearing for weeks or months at a time, then suddenly bombarding you with requests that need to be done immediately.



The best way to block a sneak attack is to be prepared; set the same expectations for all clients. If your process takes three weeks for everyone else, it will take three weeks for her, too.

Mrs. What You Did Was
Great, But We Now
Want Something
Completely Different



Dream client—until you deliver the finished project and they realize they want to go in a different direction entirely.



Make it clear that additional costs may apply if what she is asking for is far beyond the scope of the original price quote.

Mrs. We Don't Have
a Deadline—Oh, Wait,
Yes We Do and It's
Tomorrow



Flightiness, often in terms of
being out of the corporate loop.



*Agree on a timeline as soon as
possible, and remain confident in
rejecting requests that will
endanger deadlines or projects
for other clients.*

Ms. I Don't Know
What I Want,
But I Know It Isn't That



This client may not know what she wants, but she certainly knows what she doesn't want—and it's probably everything you're proposing.



This moving target has potential to cause a lot of heartache for your team; it might be best to put out the "no vacancy" sign for this client.

Mr. Will This Cost
Extra, aka,
Mr. I Emptied My
Bank Account for This



Penny-pinching, bean counting, whatever you want to call it, this client is extremely concerned about the budget—to the letter.



Agree upfront on the scope of the project—if they can't pony up more cash for extras they want, you just can't do it.

Mr. I Don't Really Care;
Just Do Whatever
You Want



Completely hands-off approach,
lack of key information even
when pressed for it.



*Take advantage of the freedom
this client provides, but always
require client buy-in at critical
stages to head off major
reworking.*

#13

Mrs. Won't This
Take Five Minutes?



A belief that she can do what you do in a much shorter time frame than is possible.



As this person is clearly detached from reality, tell her why what she wants won't take just five minutes.

Mrs. I Care So Much That It Hurts



Comes to the table with an extremely specific approach with little room for your ideas, so much so that you begin to wonder why she hired you at all.



Be clear on what she is trying to accomplish, but don't be afraid to frankly tell them when their approach won't work.

Mr./Mrs./Mrs./Mr. Decision-by- Committee



Usually housed at large corporations, this client does everything by committee—even deciding on minor wording or irrelevant aspects of projects.



Force them to agree on a single contact person responsible for a majority of the relationship, even if you are still dealing directly with others in the committee. This will allow for at least one comprehensive view of the entire project.